



SDG 4

QUALITY EDUCATION

Solution Emergent DPI approaches support improved educational outcomes. DIKSHA is a DPI operated by the Indian government that provides over 180 million students with educational resources. It also supports value-added applications using its APIs. More educational DPIs are necessary to amplify traditional learning systems

value through AI in areas of climate prediction, agricultural advisory, health research and more. AI is also being increasingly built into DPI functionalities, like with India's Bhashini, which offers openly accessible AI models for translation.

While Kaushik of Gartner believes other technologies like superapps will also be crucial, Murthy of Deloitte says Internet of Things (IoT), biometric authentication advances such as facial recognition, edge computing, cross-border payment solutions and voice and natural language processing can also be integrated into DPIs.

That does sound exciting, but the biggest challenge countries face is the lack of capacity, apart from challenges associated with scaling pilots, say experts. Coun-



SDG 5

GENDER EQUALITY

Solution Leveraging UPI reduces inequalities in financial access by reducing barriers to formal financial systems, bringing in the unbanked population, who are often women. It supports transactions in low-resource and offline environments through a suite of call-based solutions for feature phones called UPI 123Pay



SDG 6

CLEAN WATER AND SANITATION

Solution Digital Infrastructure for Governance, Impact & Transformation (DIGIT)'s water and sanitation function boosts operational efficiency of faecal sludge management. It allows people to place service requests, make payments online and check their status



SDG 8

DECENT WORK AND ECONOMIC GROWTH

Solution Open Credit Enablement Network (OCEN) is a DPI that securely shares customer credit information across India's banks, fintech companies, and other financial institutions. It has open standards and interoperability. Financial services providers can seamlessly interact with users encompassing micro, small, and medium enterprises, to digitise the underwriting, and servicing of loans. It integrates with Aadhaar for eKYC. To date, \$2 million has been disbursed

SOURCE UNDP



“For low- and middle-income countries (LMICs)...a DPI approach can reduce implementation cost and shorten the learning curve”

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tries often lack a cohesive vision to bring together funders and other players with fragmented and misaligned incentives. Even countries with political will often lack the capacity to lead large-scale technology projects. Dhar of Primus Partners explains, “DPIs need a global governance structure, standards and regulatory framework to enable seamless adoption across countries.” Also, while privacy is one of the founding principles, strong regulations and mechanisms are required to ensure data protection and privacy globally.

Despite these challenges, DPIs have the potential to effect profound changes, both in India and other countries. **BT**

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